

December

23

1897

Noche de Rábanos

The first *Noche de Rábanos* (Night of the Radishes) was held in Oaxaca, Mexico, to draw attention to the city's Christmas market. These days, revellers celebrate by carving radishes into figures and placing them together in scenes.



583

Maya queen

Yohl Ik'nal was crowned ruler of Palenque, a Maya city-state in modern-day Chiapas, Mexico. She was the first – and one of the only – female rulers that we know about in Maya history.



Also on this day

1952 **Alain Bombard**, a French biologist, completed a solo voyage across the Atlantic Ocean with no supplies of food or drink.

1970 **The World Trade Center North Tower** was finished. At 417 m (1,368 ft), it was the tallest building in the world at that time.

2007 **Nepal became a federal republic**, abolishing its monarchy.



1997

Hanukkah in Vatican City

A Hanukkah candle – a symbol of the Jewish religion and the Jewish holiday of Hanukkah – was lit in celebration for the first time in the Vatican City, the centre of the Catholic Christian faith.

Born this day

1867 **Sarah Breedlove**, Black American entrepreneur. Also known as Madam C J Walker, she was the first self-made female millionaire.